

BY ALF VAN HOOSE, News sports writer

Back into Rickwood's center field tonight—his mission, and mandate, clear—goes hustling, holler-guy, -toughly-competitive Sam Suplizio.

Somebody's got to scotch the big slide . . . somebody's got to challenge Goliath . . . somebody's got to stick the finger in the dike to save the land from flood.

Somebody has . . . or else . . . else, look out second-division, here come the Birmingham Barons.

Suplizio is about the last big hope to do a re-tooling, come-back-leading job. Since he went out July 24 in Memphis (with a separated shoulder), his Baron mates have bumbled, and they've fumbled, away the last of a once-fat seven and one-half game league lead.

The team has used every method short of suicide to lose games and distress Rickwood people. Now, as the last month of the season begins, it's fast getting "NOW, or not 'til next year."

Can Sam do the job? Maybe, maybe not. It's a tough one, perhaps too tough.

NEVER DID the Barons look more like has-beens than in meekly knuckling under that 10-0 thrashing by New Orleans last night. The Barons made more errors than hits (four to three) and at no time resembled that swaggering crew of April, May and June which horse-whipped rivals at the drop of a baseball.

Don Kildoo lefthanded the Barons like they were kids, and that was that. Milt Graff got two singles, and John Gebhard one, but the rest of the Barons could have checked their bats in the dugout.

ager Eddie Glennon were ready to say who it would be.

BARON BRIEFS—Emil Panko, squat Pel, slugger beamed by John Gabler Wednesday night, remained in the University Hospital while his mates went away to Atlanta. Panko's blood pressure fluctuated too much yesterday. Another night's observation was ordered. His injury was not considered serious.

Andy Cohen, the old Tider managing the Pels, promised Page and Glennon he'd try to knock off Atlanta as he had Birmingham. "Man, I hope we can take two of three from them," he said. "That's been a tough park for us, though."

Mobile is here for three single games, Friday, Saturday and Sunday. At Rickwood thus far, the Bears and Barons have won four games each. . . . John Wingo may go on the active roster today, too. That'll mean two current Barons will have to get off the list (with Suplizio's return). . . . Danny Ryan had to leave last night's game when a foul tip hit him on the arm. It was a painful blow, but not a serious one.

Hal Grote made a fine catch of an Al Grunwald drive against the centerfield fence last night but his bat slump continued. He and John Jaciuk have now gone hitless 18 straight times.

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